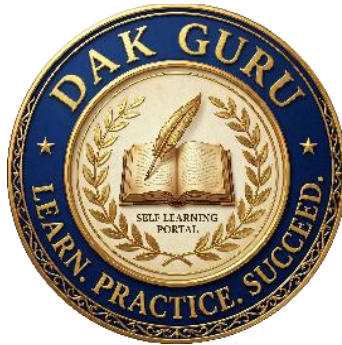


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## POSTAL MANUAL VOLUME IV ESTABLISHMENTS

**Chapters I – III • Rules 1 – 98**

*Appointments & Promotions • Transfers & Postings • Leave*

*Based on the official text uploaded by the Postal Directorate vide F. No. 20-03/2017-SPN-II dated 22.07.2019*

**Modernised, annotated and cross-verified against the latest orders in force**

### DISCLAIMER

*This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. It presents Rules 1–98 of Postal Manual Volume IV as officially published, with obsolete telegraph-era content omitted and terminology modernised, and every effort has been made to annotate the provisions with the latest amendments, orders and circulars in force. It remains a study aid only. Readers and aspirants are strongly advised to refer to the official Government gazettes, Departmental orders and primary sources for the most authoritative and up-to-date position before relying on any provision for official or examination purposes. Dak Guru / DG InfoTech accepts no liability for any loss or consequence arising from the use of this material.*

## About this Booklet — Source, Method and Modernisation

### The source text

Postal Manual Volume IV (“Establishments”) is one of the foundational service manuals of the Department. Its first three chapters — **Appointments and Promotions (General Rules), Transfers and Postings, and Leave** — comprising **Rules 1 to 98**, were uploaded to the India Post website by the Postal Directorate vide **F. No. 20-03/2017-SPN-II dated 22.07.2019**, with the approval of DDG (P). That officially uploaded text — a reprint of the Posts & Telegraphs Manual, Volume IV — is the base document for this booklet.

### What has been done to the text

The base text dates from the composite Posts & Telegraphs era. To make it a usable, current study asset, this booklet does three things:

- **Omits dead content.** Provisions relating exclusively to the Telegraphs wing (telegraph traffic, telegraph engineering, telephone districts and workshops) are omitted: the P&T Department was bifurcated in 1985 and the telegram service itself was discontinued with effect from 15.07.2013. Rules already marked “Deleted” in the official text are noted but not reproduced.
- **Modernises terminology.** Archaic designations are silently rendered in their present-day equivalents throughout (see the mapping table below), so the rules read as they apply in today’s Department of Posts.
- **Annotates for currency.** Wherever a later order, rule or circular has overlaid or modified the Manual provision, a “CURRENCY NOTE” box states the present position with the order number and date, and flags any conflict between sources explicitly.

### Terminology modernisation map

| Term in the original text     | Rendered in this booklet as | Authority / reason                      |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Posts & Telegraphs Department | Department of Posts (DoP)   | P&T bifurcated in 1985                  |
| Class IV servants / Group 'D' | Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS)   | 6th CPC; Group 'D' phased out from 2008 |

| Term in the original text                  | Rendered in this booklet as              | Authority / reason                     |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Extra-Departmental Agents (EDA)            | Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)                  | GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules, 2020 |
| CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1955 / 1959           | CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964                | 1964 Rules in force                    |
| Indian Postal Service, Class I             | Indian Postal Service, Group 'A' (IPoS)  | Post-1985 nomenclature                 |
| Postal Superintendents' Service, Class II  | Postal Services Group 'B' (PS Gr. B)     | Current cadre name                     |
| Superior service / Class IV service        | Group 'A'/'B'/'C' service                | Current classification                 |
| Dy. Accountant-General, P&T / Audit Office | Postal Accounts Office / DAP             | Departmentalised accounts              |
| by telegraph / telegram                    | by the fastest electronic means (e-mail) | Telegram ceased 15.07.2013             |

### A NOTE ON RULE NUMBERS

**Rule numbers are retained exactly as in the official text** — examiners quote them. Where a rule is marked “Deleted” in the official text, that fact is stated, because “which rule stands deleted” is itself a recurring examination point.

## Chapter I — Appointments and Promotions: General Rules (Rules 1–32E)

*Chapter I lays the foundation for the entire personnel system of the Department: who may be appointed and after what verification, the definitions of “establishment”, how orders of appointment issue, the oath and declarations every entrant must make, the leave reserve, the principles of promotion, Gazette notification of gazetted officers’ career events, and — most tested of all — the law of gradation lists and seniority.*

### 1. Scope and Powers (Rules 1–2)

#### Rule 1 — Application of the general rules

The general rules of this Chapter apply **equally to officers of all the different branches** of the service, unless a rule is otherwise expressly specified as applicable to a particular branch or a particular class of Government servants. Special rules applicable to particular branches are laid down in **Chapters V to XVIII** of this Volume.

#### Rule 2 — Powers of appointment and promotion

The powers of the **Director-General** and of **Heads of Circles** and their subordinate officers to appoint and promote officials subordinate to them are laid down in **Postal Manual, Volume III** (Schedule of administrative powers).

### 2. Verification of Character and Antecedents (Rules 3–4)

#### Rule 3 — Enquiries regarding character

Before appointing or nominating persons to vacancies in the Department — or engaging as **Gramin Dak Sevaks** — persons who do not already hold Government or quasi-Government posts or who are not Government pensioners, **careful enquiry must be made regarding their character and antecedents**. No one may be employed in the Department who is **unable to furnish satisfactory references**, and **no person who has been dismissed for misconduct from any Government post may be employed**.

Custody of the enquiry papers is precisely regulated:

- **Permanent departmental officials:** the papers showing the result of the enquiries are kept **with their character sheets or confidential records**, with a note — **duly signed and dated** — appended to the effect that the papers have been so attached.

- **Candidates (not yet permanently appointed):** the enquiry papers may be kept by the recruiting officer in a **special guard book**, arranged in the order of entries in the gradation list of such candidates, and transferred to the character sheets/confidential records as soon as they are given permanent appointments.
- **Gramin Dak Sevaks:** the enquiry papers are kept **with their security bonds**, with necessary remarks in the register of security bonds. If a GDS is exempted from furnishing a security bond, the papers are kept at the place where the bond would otherwise have been kept — i.e., in the order of entries in the register of security bonds — a necessary remark being recorded in the register.

#### NOTE TO RULE 3 — Identification statement

A statement **duly attested by the appointing officer**, containing marks of identification and other descriptive particulars **including thumb and finger impressions** as recorded on the first page of the service book or service roll, must be filed along with the enquiry papers. A similar attested statement is obtained for all GDS; in the case of **GDS Branch Postmasters**, the statement is attested by the **Inspector of Post Offices**.

#### Rule 4 — Re-employment of persons who resigned, absconded or were dismissed

Applications for re-employment *in any capacity* from persons who have been **dismissed** from the Department, or who **resigned to avoid dismissal**, or who **absconded**, must **usually be rejected**. When, however, the re-employment of any such person is considered necessary on special grounds, the **previous approval of the Director-General must always be obtained**.

### 3. Re-employment of Pensioners (Rule 5)

#### Rule 5 — Sanctioning authority and suitability

The **Head of a Circle** may sanction the re-employment of pensioners in **non-gazetted posts** under **Article 520(iii) of the Civil Service Regulations**, subject to the conditions in Article 520 *ibid*. An **appointing authority of gazetted rank** in charge of a Division or a first-class Head Post Office may *also* exercise this power — provided the pensioner re-employed is in receipt of a pension **not exceeding Rs. 100 per mensem** (the monetary ceiling of the original text; see note). **No pensioner whose past records and present circumstances are not fully satisfactory — specially in regard to financial solvency — should be considered suitable for re-employment.**

**CURRENCY NOTE — Rule 5**

The structural rule — HoC competent for non-gazetted re-employment; Divisional/first-class HPO gazetted appointing authorities competent within the pension ceiling — stands, and the **suitability test (records + financial solvency)** is a favourite examination point. The **Rs. 100 ceiling is an archaic pre-revision figure**; pay of re-employed pensioners is today regulated by the CCS (Fixation of Pay of Re-employed Pensioners) Orders, 1986, as amended, read with current DoP&T instructions. Quote the ceiling only as the Manual's text, not as a live monetary limit.

**4. Health Certificate (Rules 6–7)****Rule 6 — Medical certificate of health**

The rules regarding production of a **medical certificate of health** by a candidate for **permanent appointment** to Government service are found in **Fundamental Rule 10** and **Supplementary Rules 3, 4 and 4-A** of the Compilation of the Fundamental and Supplementary Rules.

**Rule 7 — Identification before the medical officer**

When a candidate is sent up for medical examination, he is supplied with a **letter addressed to the medical officer** furnishing a brief description of him, mentioning some **special distinguishing mark (such as a scar)** or other peculiarity by which the medical officer may identify the individual to be examined — a safeguard against impersonation.

**5. Age on Appointment (Rules 8, 10 and 10-A)****Rule 8 — Governing rules**

The rules regarding conditions of age on appointment to Government service are found in the **relevant Recruitment Rules of the cadres concerned**. (Rule 9 stands *Deleted*.)

**Rule 10 — No relaxation of the maximum age limit by Circles**

Candidates whose age exceeds the prescribed maximum age limits are **not eligible** for recruitment to the cadres concerned. The maximum age limit **cannot be relaxed by the Heads of Circles or by any subordinate authority** unless powers for such relaxation have been **specifically delegated in the Recruitment Rules**. Where no such delegation has been made, the powers vest in the **Government**, and all such cases must be **referred to the Director-General prior to recruitment**.

- **Note 1:** the age limits are applied **at the time of recruitment**. **No sanction is necessary** where a candidate is within the maximum age limit at the time of recruitment but becomes **over-aged by the time of appointment**.
- **Note 2:** where the maximum age limit *is* relaxed by the competent authority, suitable entries — with the particulars of the sanction granting the relaxation — must be made in the **Service Book** of the candidate concerned.

### Rule 10-A — Determination of domicile

For posts and services filled by direct recruitment of persons of Indian domicile — whether by competition, qualifying examination or selection — the domicile of candidates is determined in accordance with the rules in **Appendix B to Schedule IV of the Superior Civil Service Rules** (omitting Rules 5(2) and 10), reproduced as **Appendix No. 1-A** of this Manual.

## 6. Key Definitions (Rules 11–12)

### Rule 11 — “Office establishment”

#### KEY DEFINITION — Rule 11

“Office establishment” includes all non-gazetted servants engaged on clerical duties, as well as MTS employed in offices — **except sweepers**.

### Rule 12 — “Petty establishment”

“Petty establishment” includes store-keepers, artificers, guards, watchmen, messengers and MTS who are **not attached to offices**, who are employed on general duties, and whose salaries are not provided for in any estimate for a work.

#### NOTE TO RULE 12

The above definition of petty establishment **does not apply to the Post Office** — a much-tested exception. (Rules 13 and 14 stand *Deleted*.)

## 7. Orders of Appointment, Oath and Declarations (Rules 15–18)

### Rule 15 — Written orders of appointment, promotion or transfer

In **every case** in which a person — whether in Group ‘A’/‘B’/‘C’ or MTS service — is newly appointed to a permanent or officiating post, or is promoted or transferred, a **written order over the signature of the officer authorised** to make the appointment /



order the promotion or transfer will be **given to him**, and a **copy sent without delay to the official by whom his pay will be drawn**. In the case of transfers of Post Office officials from the jurisdiction of one Head Post Office to that of another, a copy is **also sent to the postmaster by whom the pay of the person transferred was last drawn**.

### Rule 16 — Oath of allegiance and service declarations

Before a person newly appointed to a post is allowed to **assume his duties**, the Controlling Officer arranges for the **administration of an oath of allegiance** to him, recording a note to that effect — if the oath was taken orally — in his confidential record or character sheet. **Conscientious objectors to oath-taking may make a solemn affirmation** to the same effect. The prescribed form is:

#### FORM OF OATH / AFFIRMATION (Rule 16)

*“I, A. B., do swear / solemnly affirm that I will be faithful and bear true allegiance to India and to the Constitution of India as by law established, that I will uphold the sovereignty and integrity of India, and that I will carry out the duties of my office loyally, honestly and with impartiality. (So help me God.)”*

The Controlling Officer also obtains prescribed **declarations**:

- From officials handling secret communications (e.g. postal signallers): a declaration of having read the **Indian Official Secrets Act** and the **CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964**, with a clear understanding of the liabilities and penalties they entail on appointment.
- From all other officials in Group ‘A’/‘B’/‘C’ service, all MTS, and GDS: a declaration of having **read (or had explained to them) the CCS (Conduct) Rules** and thoroughly understood them.
- From all officials and GDS — **except GDS mail carriers and GDS delivery agents** who are not entrusted with the delivery of accountable articles and are not required to furnish security — a declaration of having read (or had explained) the amended **Rule 103 of Postal Manual Volume II** and agreeing to abide by its terms.
- Persons **not knowing English**: the declarations are prepared in a **local Indian language**.

The declarations are **attached to the character sheets or confidential records** of the officials concerned — and, for GDS, to their **security bonds** (with the same exemption-handling as under Rule 3). Each appointing authority maintains a **record of the**



**oath/affirmation in a separate register for each grade** it is empowered to appoint, in the following form:

| Sl. No. | Name of Govt. servant | Date oath / affirmation taken | Oath or affirmation | Designation of officer before whom made | Signature of officer |
|---------|-----------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------|
| 1       | 2                     | 3                             | 4                   | 5                                       | 6                    |

### Rule 17 — Security to be stated in the appointment order

When an **outsider** is newly appointed to a permanent or officiating post in which **security has to be furnished**, the officer making the appointment must **specifically state in the order of appointment whether the person appointed has furnished security or not**.

### Rule 18 — Compensatory allowance eligibility

There must be a **clear understanding at the time a clerk is engaged** on the question whether he is or is not eligible for **compensatory allowance**; the officer having the power to appoint makes a note to this effect **in the letter of appointment and in the orders of appointment**.

## 8. Leave Reserve (Rules 18/1–18/2)

### Rule 18/1 — Sanctioned strength of the leave reserve

A staff of clerks **not exceeding 14 per cent of the operative clerical staff** is sanctioned to form a **leave reserve**, which provides for all vacancies caused by the absence on leave of officials of the clerical class of the offices concerned — in the modern establishment, the **offices of the Postmasters-General and the administrative offices under their control** (the original list also covered stores, workshop, accounts and telephone-district offices of the composite P&T Department).

### Rule 18/2 — When the reserve is exhausted

In a non-gazetted establishment having a sanctioned leave reserve — including the office of the Director-General — when the number of absentees (whether on ordinary leave or on leave on medical certificate) **equals or exceeds the reserve**, the grant of further leave is subject to the condition that **no extra expenditure is caused thereby to the State**. When in such circumstances it is necessary to grant **leave on medical certificate**, officiating arrangements can be made and **outsiders employed** in the leave vacancies so caused —

but such arrangements must **cease, and the outsiders be discharged, as soon as the total number of absentees on leave of all kinds is brought within the sanctioned leave reserve.**

**EXAM TIP — Two different leave-reserve percentages**

Do not confuse the two reserves: **Rule 18/1 of this Chapter — 14% of the operative clerical staff of administrative offices**; the establishment-review norms elsewhere in Volume IV provide a **10% leave reserve for operative offices**. Both figures appear in question papers; the context (administrative vs operative office) decides the answer.

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## 9. Transfer of Service to Another Government Office or Department (Rule 19)

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### Rule 19 — Applications for outside posts

The conditions governing requests of Government servants to transfer their services to another Government office or department are prescribed in the **Government Servants' Applications for Posts (Central Service Rules)**. These rules, along with the instructions issued by Government under them for the guidance of the authorities receiving the applications, are given in **Appendix 22** of this Manual. (Rules 20 to 23 stand *Deleted*.)

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## 10. Promotion to Higher Posts (Rules 24–27B)

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### Rule 24 — The basic principle

It is to be understood that **no officer is to be promoted to fill a vacancy in a higher grade unless he is considered deserving of advancement**. Promotion is a recognition of fitness, never a mechanical entitlement.

### Rule 25 — Promotion to Senior Time Scale (seniority-cum-fitness)

The Government of India have decided that promotion to the grade of **Senior Time Scale of the Indian Postal Service, Group 'A'** should be made from the cadre of the **Junior Time Scale** of that service **by seniority, subject to the rejection of the unfit**. Ordinarily an officer should **not be superseded** until he has been **tried during a period of probation** — which confers *no claim to eventual confirmation* — in an officiating capacity; but an officiating appointment **will be refused to an officer who is obviously unsuitable**.

### Rule 26 — Promotion by selection

Promotion to the grades mentioned below is **by selection from the best officers** in the Department, **seniority being regarded only where other qualifications are practically equal**. On the postal side the listed grades are:

- Deputy Director-General;
- Postmaster-General;
- Director of Postal Services;
- Chief Postmaster of a GPO (historically “Presidency Postmaster”);
- Assistant Deputy Director-General, and Junior Time Scale of the Indian Postal Service, Group ‘A’;
- Postal Services Group ‘B’ (historically “Postal Superintendents’ Service, Class II”);

- Postmaster cadre (historically “Postmaster Service, Class II”); and, on the general side, Accounts Officers.

#### NOTE TO RULE 26

Selection for the posts of **Assistant Deputy Director-General** is generally made from among officers **not above the age of 50 years** — a small detail examiners like.

### Rule 27 — Officiating appointments against approved DPC lists

For officiating appointments, once the lists of approved officers are prepared by **Departmental Promotion Committees** and finally approved by Government or the appointing authority, **no departure from the order in the list should ordinarily be made**. When administrative exigencies require it, however, a person **not in the list, or not first in order in the list, may be appointed for a period not exceeding three months**.

#### Rule 27-A — Training period counts on active service

Where a period of training is fixed, it must ordinarily be spent **on active service**: in calculating the time spent on training for the purpose of **confirmation**, leave **other than casual leave** must be excluded. **Note**: the Director-General has **discretionary powers to make any exception** to this rule.

#### Rule 27-B — Promotion to selection grades of the clerical cadre

Promotion to the lower or higher selection grade of the clerical cadre is made **normally in order of seniority**, but the appointing authority may, in his discretion, **pass over any senior official whom he does not consider fit** for such promotion. The rule’s celebrated illustration: where the first three senior men are *all fit* for promotion — the first *good*, the second *better*, the third *best* — **the first man, and not the third or the second, should be promoted**. Fitness opens the gate; seniority then decides. (Rule 28 stands *Deleted*.)

## 11. Gazette Notifications and Schedule of Appointments (Rules 29–30)

### Rule 29 — Events notified in the Gazette of India

Every **important event in the official career of a gazetted Government servant** affecting his pay and other conditions of service — e.g. **appointment, promotions, leave, retirement, reversion, suspension, removal, dismissal** — should be **notified in the Gazette of India**. Appointment of an officer to hold **current charge of the routine duties** of a gazetted post does **not** require notification where it involves no change in his emoluments — but such appointment *should* be notified if it is considered desirable to

publicise it, or if the officer is required to **countersign bills as a controlling officer** or exercise **statutory or other powers** conferred on holders of the post. Notifications made by the **Government of India** are published in **Part I Section 2**, and those by the **Director-General and Heads of Circles/Administrative Offices** in **Part III Section 1**, of the Gazette of India.

### Rule 30 — Appointments requiring previous sanction of the Government of India

Appointments — whether **substantive or officiating** — to the following posts require the **previous sanction of the Government of India** and are notified in the Gazette of India by them. On the postal side:

- Director-General;
- Senior Deputy Director-General and Deputy Directors-General;
- Postmasters-General;
- Officers of the Indian Postal Service, Group 'A';
- Assistant Deputy Directors-General; and
- Chief Postmasters of GPOs (historically “Presidency Postmasters”).

#### CURRENCY NOTE — Rule 30 today

The mechanism survives in modern form: senior appointments (Members of the Postal Services Board, DDsG, CPMsG/PMsG and IPoS Group 'A' postings at that level) are made with the approval of the competent authority of the Government of India — today routed through the **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** where applicable — and notified in the Gazette.

## 12. Classification of Staff (Rule 31)

Rule 31 lists the **Ministerial and Non-Ministerial** servants of the Department — a classification that matters for service conditions and office procedure. The original list is exhaustively P&T-era; the categories of present relevance are:

| Wing                                                        | Ministerial staff includes (illustrative, modernised)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Circle & Administrative Offices                             | Office Superintendents; Sorting Assistant Superintendents; Head Assistants (HSG); Head Clerks (LSG); Senior/Junior Accountants; all officials in the cadres of Inspector of Post Offices and Inspector, Railway Mail Service; Librarians; Store-keepers; UDCs; LDCs; Stenographers; Typists; Cash Overseers; Stock Verifiers; HSG Clerks; Assistant Superintendents of Post Offices                                                                                           |
| Post Offices                                                | Postmasters, Dy. Postmasters, Sub-Postmasters and Assistant Postmasters (HSG & LSG); Sub-Postmasters (Time Scale); Branch Postmasters; Inspectors of Post Offices; Complaint and Town Inspectors; Head Clerks of Divisional Offices; Supervisors (Selection Grade); Post Office Accountants and Assistant Accountants; Postal Assistants; Steno-typists; Treasurers and Assistant Treasurers; Mail and Cash Overseers; the Postman line; Head Assistants; Supervisor Accounts |
| Railway Mail Service (incl. Foreign Post)                   | Assistant Superintendents (HSG); Sorting Assistant Superintendents; Inspectors; Head Record Clerks; Record and Sub-Record Clerks; Head Clerks and Clerks; Sorting Assistants (all grades); Platform Inspectors; Selection Grade Supervisors; Accountants; Sorting and Check Supervisors; Mail Agents; Mail Guards; Bag Clerks; Head Sorters (HSG)                                                                                                                             |
| Returned Letter Offices / Stock Depots / Mail Motor Service | Managers and Assistant Managers; LSG (Supervisory) Clerks; Time-Scale Supervisors; Clerks; Forms Supervisors; Junior Accountants; Head Clerks; Log Book and Traffic Supervisors                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

#### EDITORIAL NOTE — Rule 31

The original Rule 31 devotes many pages to telegraph, telephone-district and workshop designations and to lists of pensionable and non-pensionable Class IV categories dating to 1912–1951; these are of historical interest only and are omitted here. Present-day classification of posts follows the **Group 'A'/'B'/'C' scheme** under the CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965 read with the cadre-specific Recruitment Rules. One note from the original list remains worth memorising: **leave-reserve staff of a cadre are also ministerial.**

### 13. Gradation Lists (Rules 32-A to 32-D)

### Rule 32-A — The Circle Gradation List

A Head of a Circle publishes — **once in two years** per the official text (see the currency note below) — and issues copies to all offices concerned, **as also to the Director-General, a Circle Gradation List corrected up to the 1st of July**. The list shows the names and other particulars of the prescribed classes of officials under his control, together with **statistical information** on the various classes of non-gazetted staff employed in the entire Circle — their sanctioned strength, scales of pay and allowances. The classes covered include gazetted officers of each class in each branch; supervisors; **clerical staff in selection grades and in the first grade and first division** (including postmasters, sub-postmasters, record clerks, sorters, etc.) according to each cadre in each branch; and **Inspectors of Post Offices and Head Clerks to Superintendents of Post Offices, and Inspectors, Railway Mail Service**. The list **may be published in parts** according to each branch or group of branches, as the Head of the Circle considers suitable.

### Rule 32-B — Gradation lists of other appointing authorities

Any **other appointing authority** (e.g. a Divisional head) keeps a gradation list of **all officials appointments to whose posts, if vacant, are made by him** — as also of other officials under his control who are ordinarily liable to be transferred by him, or qualified for promotion to higher-grade appointments made by him, or whose names, though shown in the Director-General's list of officers of the Department or in the Circle Gradation List, are not shown therein in a separate list. This list is **issued in the years in which the Circle Gradation List is required to be issued, corrected up to 1st July** of that year, to all offices concerned — as also to his **immediate superior**, to whom a **certificate** is also submitted to the effect that the gradation lists of all classes of officials to be kept by him are **duly maintained and kept up-to-date**. An authority immediately subordinate to the Head of a Circle also submits to the latter, in **July** of the year in which the Circle Gradation List is to be published, a copy of the relevant list corrected up to 1st July in so far as the staff under his control are concerned, to enable the Circle list to be compiled.

### Rule 32-C — Form and maintenance

All gradation lists are maintained in **Form App. 44**. In each list the names of the officials of **each class are entered separately and in strict order of seniority, one or more pages being left blank after each class** for updates. Each list must be **kept corrected up-to-date**, and may be maintained **in print or in manuscript** at the discretion of the authority required to maintain it. **Note:** when there are two or more officials of the **same name** in a



particular cadre, they are distinguished by **serial numbers** placed against their names, these numbers being quoted whenever the names are recorded.

### Rule 32-D — Circulation, errors and appeals

Heads of offices arrange to have all gradation lists received by them **circulated among the staff concerned as soon as received**, so that officials can see at once how they stand in the list. If there is any **mistake** in a gradation list, the official(s) affected must point it out to the authority concerned for rectification **within one year of the date of issue of the gradation list** — or else the petition is treated as **time-barred**. If, after the issue of a gradation list, the **seniority of an official is altered to his disadvantage**, the authority ordering the alteration must **communicate the fact to him; no appeal** against such alteration lies to a higher authority **unless it is submitted within the usual time-limit of six months** from the date of communication of the order appealed against. No such intimation of alteration is issued where seniority is altered in pursuance of a **general order of the Director-General** regulating the fixation of seniority — e.g. where an official *fails to pass the efficiency bar on the due date, or cannot be confirmed in his appointment on the due date owing to inefficiency*.

#### CURRENCY NOTE — Periodicity of gradation lists (sources conflict)

The officially uploaded text of Rule 32-A prescribes publication **once in two years**, with other authorities' lists following the same cycle (Rule 32-B). Later administrative practice and secondary sources, however, cite revised periodicities — a November 2024 compilation states **Circle Gradation Lists every 6 years and Divisional Gradation Lists every 3 years**, while some study materials cite 5 years for the Circle list. **These sources conflict, and no single consolidated amendment could be verified from primary sources.** For the examination, the Manual text (once in two years, corrected up to 1st July, Form App. 44) is the safest citation; for official work, verify your Circle's current instructions before quoting a periodicity.

## 14. Seniority (Rule 32-E)

### Rule 32-E — Fixation of seniority

Subject to any special rules prescribed for a particular service, the seniority of an official in the cadre to which he belongs is fixed **according to the date of his permanent appointment to that cadre**. When this date happens to be **the same** in the case of two or more officials, seniority is determined according to the following principles:

| Mode of recruitment                                             | Tie-breaker for seniority                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (a)(i) Examination — competitive                                | Order of merit in the examination; where recruitment is made partly from departmental candidates and partly from outsiders, the departmental candidates always rank senior to the latter |
| (a)(ii) Examination — qualifying                                | Position of the official on the waiting list                                                                                                                                             |
| (b)(i) Promotion — pure selection                               | <b>Order of preference</b>                                                                                                                                                               |
| (b)(ii) Promotion — seniority subject to rejection of the unfit | Position of the official in the cadre from which promoted                                                                                                                                |

### EXAM TIP — The four-branch seniority tree

Memorise Rule 32-E as a tree: **Examination** → **competitive (order of merit; departmental ranks senior to outsider)** or **qualifying (waiting-list position)**. **Promotion** → **pure selection (order of preference)** or **seniority-cum-fitness (feeder-cadre position)**. Nearly every seniority MCQ from Volume IV maps onto one of these four branches. In modern practice this rule is read with DoP&T's general seniority instructions (e.g. OM No. 20011/5/90-Estt(D) dated 04.11.1992: seniority follows the order of merit at initial appointment, unaffected by category; rotation of DR/DP vacancies per OM dated 03.07.1986).

## Chapter II — Transfers and Postings (Rules 33–90)

*Chapter II is the transfer law of the Department: the universal liability to transfer, the April timing rule, the celebrated Rule 38 on transfer at one's own request with its seniority consequences, the mechanics of transfer of charge, the procedure for filling short-term vacancies, and the rotation-of-charges regime with its cadre-wise tenure table. Rules 63–71 and 78–90 of the original text relate exclusively to the Telegraph Traffic and Telegraph Engineering branches and are omitted; Rules 65–68-B, 76, 77 and 79 stand Deleted in the official text.*

### 1. General Rules and Powers (Rules 33–36)

#### Rule 33 — Application

The general rules of this Chapter apply **equally to officers of all branches** unless otherwise expressly specified for a particular branch or class of Government servants. Further rules regarding “**Transfer of office**” are given in the **Postal Financial Handbook, Volume I**.

#### Rule 34 — Powers

The powers of the **Director-General, the Head of a Circle and subordinate authorities** to sanction transfers and postings of a member of the Department are laid down in the **Schedule of administrative powers in Postal Manual, Volume III**.

#### Rule 35 — Communication of gazetted officers' movements

All **transfers, changes of headquarters and special duties of gazetted officers** must be communicated to the **Director-General and to the Postal Accounts Office** as laid down in the Postal Financial Handbook, Volume I.

#### Rule 36 — Transfers otherwise than for public convenience

The rules regarding transfers of officials *otherwise than for the public convenience* are found in **Part VII of the Administrative Instructions** issued by the Governor-General in Council and published as **Appendix No. 3** to the Compilation of the Fundamental and Supplementary Rules.

### 2. Liability and Timing of Transfers (Rules 37 and 37-A)

#### Rule 37 — Universal liability to transfer

All officials of the Department are **liable to be transferred to any part of India** unless it is expressly ordered otherwise for any particular class or classes of officials. Transfers

should **not, however, be ordered** except when advisable in the interests of the public service. Postmen, village postmen and MTS should not, **except for very special reasons**, be transferred from one district to another. All transfers are subject to the conditions laid down in **Fundamental Rules 15 and 22**.

### Rule 37-A — April transfers

Transfers should generally be made in **April** of each year so that the **education of school-going children of the staff is not dislocated**. In **emergent cases or cases of promotion** this restriction will naturally not operate.

## 3. Transfer at One's Own Request (Rule 38)

### Rule 38(1) — The general rule and mutual exchange

Transfers of officials when desired *for their own convenience* should **not be discouraged if they can be made without injury to the rights of others**. As a general rule, however, an official should **not be transferred from one unit to another — within the same Circle or to another Circle — unless he is permanent**. Because it is not possible to accommodate an official borne on one gradation list into another gradation list without injury to the other members of that list, such transfers should **not ordinarily be allowed except by way of mutual exchange**. Transfers by mutual exchange, if in themselves inherently unobjectionable, should be allowed — but, to safeguard the rights of the men borne in the gradation lists of both offices, the official brought in takes, in the new gradation list, **the place he would have been assigned had he been originally recruited in that unit, or the place vacated by the official with whom he exchanges appointment — whichever is the lower**.

#### NOTE TO RULE 38(1)

Transfer of officials who are **not permanent in the grade** may, in deserving cases, be permitted with the **personal approval of the Head of Circle / Administrative Office**.

### Rule 38(2) — Seniority on transfer without mutual exchange

When an official is transferred at his own request **without arranging a mutual exchange**, he ranks **junior in the gradation list of the new unit to all officials of that unit on the date on which the transfer order issued** — including all persons already approved for appointment to that grade as on that date. Own-request transfer therefore always costs local seniority.

**Rule 38(3) — Seniority in the wider unit**

If the old and the new unit form parts of a **wider unit for the purpose of promotion to a higher cadre**, the transferee — whether by mutual exchange or otherwise — **retains his original seniority in the gradation list of the wider unit**. The Manual's illustrations, modernised:

- **Example (i):** a Postal Assistant transferred from Mehsana Division to Kaira Division *in the same Circle* does not lose his seniority in the **Circle gradation list for promotion to the Lower Selection Grade**.
- **Example (iii):** an RMS Sorting Assistant transferred from the 'A' Division to the 'P' Division has his seniority in the gradation list of the P Division — as well as of the Bihar Circle — fixed in accordance with sub-rule (2).
- **Example (iv):** a Postal Assistant transferred from Poona Division to the Bombay GPO has his seniority fixed under sub-rule (2) *both* in the gradation list of the Bombay GPO *and* in that of the Bombay City units — because the City units and the mofussil units maintain **separate** gradation lists for LSG promotion.
- **Example (v):** a clerk transferred from one zone to another in the Stores Organisation has his seniority fixed in the new zone's gradation list under sub-rule (2).

**Rule 38(4) — Lien, and the declaration before transfer**

A permanent official transferred from one unit to another **retains his lien in the old unit until he can be accommodated in the new unit** according to his position there. He will, however, have **no claim to go back to his old unit** even though he holds his lien there. Before an official is transferred under this rule, a **declaration** must be obtained from him to the effect that he **accepts the seniority on transfer in accordance with this rule and will have no claim to go back to the old unit**. Any **special privilege** to which an official may be entitled by virtue of his position in the gradation list of the unit from which he is transferred is, ordinarily, **forfeited** on his transfer to a new gradation list.

**Rule 38(5) — Transfer from one arm of the service to another**

The transfer of an official from **one arm of the service to another** — within or outside the Circle — can be allowed only with the **personal approval of the Head(s) of the Circle(s) concerned**, and subject to the following conditions:

- (a) the **mode of recruitment** to the post to which the official seeks transfer is **the same** as for the post he is holding; and

- (b) whenever **additional qualifications** are prescribed for appointment to a certain post, the applicant must satisfy those conditions in all respects; whenever any **training** is required or prescribed for the post, the applicant must undergo that training satisfactorily, the period being covered by the official **taking leave due and permissible**.

#### CURRENCY NOTE — Rule 38 as operated today (VERIFIED)

Rule 38 remains the statutory foundation, but its day-to-day operation is now governed by consolidated Directorate guidelines: **F. No. 141-141/2013-SPB-II dated 17.01.2019**, modified by **No. X-12/6/2021-SPN-II dated 17.11.2021**, and the consolidated online-portal guidelines of **03.02.2023** with subsequent clarifications (e.g. 10.06.2024 on the 72-hour decline window; October 2025 on vacancy assessment).

Key operative features today: applications only through the **online transfer portal**; eligibility after **one year of service** (waived for PwBD, terminal illness of self/spouse/dependent children, and compassionate-appointment cases); **two Inter-Circle + two Intra-Circle chances** in the entire service, with a **3-year gap** for a second transfer in the same category and **one additional chance for PwBD**; transfers processed **quarterly (March / June / September / December)**; relieving not to be denied if the working strength of the cadre is **not below 66.66%**; relieving within **30 days, extendable to 60 days** on the official's written request. The seniority principles of sub-rules (2)–(4) — bottom seniority in the new unit; the mutual-exchange “whichever is lower” rule — continue in the modern guidelines. A companion Dak Guru booklet covers the current framework in full detail.

## 4. Restrictions and Movement Reports (Rules 39–40)

### Rule 39 — Medical officers not to recommend transfers

A Government medical officer is **prohibited**, under the rules of his Department, from recommending that an official be transferred from — or excused from proceeding to — a particular station **on the score of health**; nor is he at liberty to offer an opinion as to the nature of the duties or the place of employment of an official **unless requested to do so by the official's superior**.

### Rule 40 — Movement reports of transferred gazetted officers

Every gazetted officer transferred from one station to another must **report his movements** to the officer under whose immediate orders he is proceeding to serve. The

reports are made: **first, on being relieved; secondly, on starting; and afterwards once a week while in progress to join.**

## 5. Transfer of Charge (Rules 41–48)

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### Rule 41 — Governing instructions

The rules regarding the **transfer of the charge of an office** are found in Part II of the Administrative Instructions published as Appendix No. 3 to the Compilation of the Fundamental and Supplementary Rules.

### Rule 42 — Orders of transfer to be specific

The orders of transfer must **in each case specify in detail how the transfer is to be carried out** — i.e. to or from whom, and under what circumstances, each official concerned will make or take over charge, and whether charge is to be relinquished or assumed *on a specified date* or *as each official is relieved*. In special cases, the Head of a Circle may authorise two officers to **exchange charges by the fastest electronic means** (the original text: by telegraph). As a general rule, when two officers are to exchange charges, the officer to be first relieved should be ordered to **make over charge to one of the next senior officers**, who will hold charge temporarily until relieved.

### Rule 43 — Charge report where there is no counterpart

Where an officer is **relieved of a charge without making it over to anyone**, he signs the charge report in **Form A.C.G.-61 alone** as *having relinquished charge*, altering the entries to suit the case. Where an officer **takes over charge of an appointment not held by another officer**, he signs the charge report alone as *having assumed charge*.

### Rule 44 — No departure before the successor arrives

A transferred officer may **not, without urgent necessity or special orders of the Head of the Circle, leave the station before the arrival of the permanent successor**; and there must be **no delay in making over charge** after the arrival of the relieving officer.

### Rule 45 — Verification before signing the charge report

When the charge of an office is transferred from one officer to another, the relieving officer must, **before signing the charge report**, check the several books, registers and accounts of the office — **including stores and all valuables** — and **verify the balances in hand** as prescribed in Articles 268 to 270 of the Postal Financial Handbook, Volume I.



**Rule 46 — Informal leave of a head of office**

When the head of an office is granted **informal leave**, it rests with the **authority granting the leave** to decide how far the preceding provisions are to be observed in making over charge. **Cash, stamps and other valuables of the office must, however, be taken charge of**, and a **formal charge report** signed by the relieving and relieved officials and submitted to the officer sanctioning the leave.

**Rule 47 — Disagreement between the officers**

In the event of any **disagreement between the relieved and the relieving officers**, a reference should be made to the **Head of the Circle**.

**Rule 48 — Reports of transfers of charge of gazetted officers**

Reports of transfers of charge of gazetted officers — including Heads of Circles and Postal Accountants — should be sent **by post (and not by telegraph)** to the **next higher authority, the Accounts Officer concerned and the Director-General**, in Form A.C.G.-61. When a **non-gazetted officer is appointed to officiate in a post which entitles him to gazetted rank**, a copy of the charge report should **also be sent to the head of the office in which the non-gazetted officer was employed**.

**6. Officers Attached to Circles or Divisions (Rule 49)****Rule 49 — Station intimations in duplicate**

Intimations of the date on which officers who are **merely attached** to Circles or Divisions **leave or join their stations** should be sent **in duplicate** to the Head of the Circle or the Superintendents in charge, as the case may be.

**7. Transfers to Fill Temporary Vacancies (Rule 50)****Rule 50 — Short-term vacancy arrangements**

Transfers of non-gazetted officials to fill up **temporary vacancies** should be **avoided whenever practicable**. The following procedure is followed in making arrangements to fill vacancies of short duration:

- (1) **Cadres promoted from officials working in the same office or station:** in vacancies of **not more than one month's duration**, officiating arrangements may be **confined to the officials in the section or branch of the office, or in the sub-office, where the vacancy occurs** — even if this involves the **supersession of a senior**

**qualified official available elsewhere** in the cadre by a junior official who is actually appointed to act.

- **(2) Cadres promoted from officials in different stations, sub-divisions or divisions of a Circle:** a distinction is made between **(a) vacancies of not more than one month** and **(b) vacancies of more than one month but not more than four months**. In case (a), the officiating arrangement may be confined to the officials **at the station** where the vacancy occurs (in multi-office stations, at the sanctioning authority's discretion, to the *office* where the vacancy occurs) — on the same supersession terms as above. In case (b), the arrangement may be confined to the officials in the **Office, Sub-division or Division** where the vacancy occurs, on the same conditions.
- **(3) Special circumstances:** where strict adherence to the above procedure is not practicable or desirable from the administrative point of view, the sanctioning authority may **at his discretion make acting arrangements according to administrative requirements**.

**EXAM TIP — Rule 50's "1-month / 4-month" ladder**

**Same office/station cadre → ≤ 1 month: fill from within the section/branch/sub-office. Different-station cadre → ≤ 1 month: fill within the station; > 1 to ≤ 4 months: fill within the Office/Sub-division/Division.** Supersession of seniors elsewhere is expressly tolerated for these short arrangements. The 4-month ceiling is why Volume IV elsewhere describes officiating arrangements for short-term vacancies as "not exceeding 4 months".

## 8. Transit Memo and Charge Reports — PO & RMS (Rules 51–56)

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### Rule 51 — The transit memo (Form A.C.G.-76)

A copy of the **transit memo in Form A.C.G.-76** is received by the Head of the Circle or the Superintendent — from the head postmaster or head record clerk, as the case may be, of the office to whose jurisdiction the official is transferred — in respect of every official whose travelling-allowance bill the Head of the Circle or the Superintendent countersigns. The memo is **examined with reference to the travelling allowance bill** of the official and the **joining time checked**; if the joining time has been exceeded, or any other error is found, instructions are issued to the head postmaster or head record clerk on how to adjust the matter and, if necessary, it is brought to the notice of the Accounts office. If **no error** is found, the memo is **initialled by the countersigning officer and filed** in his office.

### Rule 52 — Charge reports of non-gazetted officials

In the case of non-gazetted officers whose pay is drawn on establishment pay-bills, **every transfer or assumption of charge must be reported by post on the same day**, in the prescribed form of charge report (**Form A.C.G.-61**), to the **Superintendent** — or, in the case of postmasters not subordinate to the Superintendent, to the **Head of the Circle**. Similarly, in the case of **MTS**, a transfer or assumption of charge must be reported to the head office concerned in a charge report **duly signed by the official if he is literate**; if he is **illiterate**, the charge report is filled up by the head, sub- or branch postmaster or the overseer concerned, and the **thumb impression of the illiterate employee is taken on the charge report in the place provided for signature**.

### Rule 53 — Selection-grade Sorting Assistants and Head Record Clerks

Transfers of Sorting Assistants holding **selection-grade appointments** are reported to the **Head of the Circle**. Transfers of **head record clerks** are, **in addition**, reported to the **local post offices**.

### Rule 54 — Reports by head postmasters, Inspectors and head clerks

Postmasters of head offices who are subordinate to the Superintendent, **Inspectors and Superintendents' head clerks** must **also report every transfer or assumption of charge to the Head of the Circle**.

### Rule 55 — Copies to the pay-drawing office

A copy of the charge report showing the **date of making over charge** is sent to the postmaster or head record clerk, as the case may be, **by whom the relieved officer's pay was last drawn**; and, in the case of an officer posted to a new appointment or to a vacant charge, a copy showing the **date of assumption of charge** is forwarded to the postmaster or head record clerk **by whom his pay will be drawn for the first time in his new appointment**. **All copies of the charge report are signed by both the relieved and the relieving officers.**

### Rule 56 — Blank forms where there is no head/sub/record office

Where the charge to be relinquished or taken over is **not in a head office, head record office, sub-office or record office / sub-record office**, a sufficient number of **blank charge report forms** is sent with the orders of transfer or appointment to both the relieved and the relieving officers.

#### NOTE TO RULE 56 — Overseers who carry cash

When an overseer who is required to **convey or escort cash** is transferred or newly appointed, notice is given by the Superintendent to the **Central Office of the beat and all the offices which are served by the overseer**; and if the overseer is a **new man or is not known** to any particular postmaster, or sub- or branch postmaster, the notice must, when necessary, contain a **sufficient description of the overseer to prevent the possibility of personation**.

## 9. Rotation of Charges and Tenure of Posts (Rules 57–62A)

### Rule 57 — Divisional heads

Ordinarily a **Superintendent of Post Offices or of the Railway Mail Service should not remain in charge of the same Division for more than four years at a time**; and an **Assistant Director of Postal Services** should likewise not occupy that post for **more than four years at one stretch**.

### Rule 58 — Cross-experience between PO and RMS

Every Superintendent of Post Offices should hold charge of a **Railway Mail Service Division for at least four years**, and every RMS Superintendent should hold charge of a **Postal Division for not less than four years**. **Note:** the provisions of this rule **do not apply to Superintendents who are above 45 years of age**.

**Rule 59 — ASPs and Inspectors**

An **Assistant Superintendent of Post Offices or RMS, and an Inspector of Post Offices or RMS**, should not ordinarily remain in the **same Division or Sub-Division, or at the same post, for more than 4 years at a time**. While ordering transfer or promotion of these officials, care should be taken to ensure that they are **not transferred to, or posted in, their home areas**.

**Rule 60 — The tenure table**

The following posts should **not ordinarily be occupied by the same officials continuously** at a time for more than the period shown against each (telegraph-wing items omitted):

| Item    | Post / duty                                                                                                               | Maximum tenure |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 1       | Head clerks of Superintendents                                                                                            | 4 years        |
| 2       | Investigating inspectors and sorting inspectors in Circle Offices                                                         | 4 years        |
| 3       | Head clerks of sections in Circle Offices                                                                                 | 4 years        |
| 4       | Clerks in GPOs / first-class head post offices dealing with staff cases                                                   | 4 years        |
| 5       | Time-scale clerks in offices of Superintendents of POs and RMS (except sorting clerks in offices of Superintendents, RMS) | 4 years        |
| 6       | Clerks in the correspondence and accounts branches of head post offices                                                   | 4 years        |
| 6-A     | Time-scale clerks working in the Philatelic Bureau                                                                        | 4 years        |
| 6-B(i)  | MTS, time-scale clerks and LSG officials in all branches of Foreign Post (except Store, MO & CED and strong rooms)        | 4 years        |
| 6-B(ii) | MTS, time-scale clerks and LSG officials in Store, MO & CED and strong rooms of Foreign Post                              | 2 years        |

| Item | Post / duty                                                                                                                                                                                       | Maximum tenure                                                               |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6-C  | LDCs / UDCs / supervisory staff (Junior/Senior Accountants and Accountants in SSG) in SBCO / ICO in all offices                                                                                   | <b>Annual rotation among themselves (offices with more than one LDC/UDC)</b> |
| 7    | Non-gazetted head postmasters                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>3 years</b>                                                               |
| 8    | Non-gazetted sub-postmasters                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>3 years</b>                                                               |
| 8-A  | Departmental Branch Postmasters                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>3 years</b>                                                               |
| 9    | Town Inspectors                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>3 years</b>                                                               |
| 9-A  | Clerks in post offices having one clerk besides the sub-postmaster                                                                                                                                | <b>3 years</b>                                                               |
| 10   | Other post office clerks (including LSG and HSG) who handle cash or valuables                                                                                                                     | <b>1 year</b>                                                                |
| 11   | Clerks in charge of Savings Bank and sub-accounts departments                                                                                                                                     | <b>6 months</b>                                                              |
| 12   | Sorting clerks in offices of Superintendents, RMS                                                                                                                                                 | <b>5 years</b>                                                               |
| 13   | Village postmen attached to offices having two or more village postmen                                                                                                                            | <b>6 months</b>                                                              |
| 14   | Time-scale Accountants in HPOs where there is more than one HPO in a Division on the same scale of pay (in single-handed offices, the Sub-Postmaster is invariably transferred every three years) | <b>4 years</b>                                                               |
| 15   | Sorting Assistants in Record Offices and Sub-Record Offices                                                                                                                                       | <b>4 years</b>                                                               |
| 15-A | LSG and HSG Sorting Assistants in RMS offices                                                                                                                                                     | <b>4 years</b>                                                               |
| 16   | Clerks in Returned Letter Offices who handle cash or valuables                                                                                                                                    | <b>1 year</b>                                                                |
| 17   | Clerks (including cashiers and store-keepers) in the different sections of the Mail Motor Service organisation under the control of Gazetted Managers                                             | <b>4 years</b>                                                               |

| Item | Post / duty                                                                                                                         | Maximum tenure |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 18   | Cashiers in Postal Training Centres, Mail Motor Service, offices of Accounts Officers, Stores organisations and Postal Store Depots | 4 years        |
| 19   | HSG and LSG officials and clerks in Postal Stores Depots not declared as independent units                                          | 4 years        |

- **Note to item 6-A:** the Divisional Superintendent / PPM / Gazetted Postmaster working directly under the Head of the Circle may, at his discretion, order the transfer of the staff working in the Philatelic Bureau **any time before completion of the 4-year tenure for administrative reasons.**
- **Note to item 11:** the Divisional authorities may, in their discretion, **extend the tenure up to two years** for staff working in the Savings Bank branch of head offices and sub-offices whose status is **not lower than LSG.**
- **Note to item 14:** the scale Accountants in head post offices **can be rotated with such Accountants in the Postal Divisional Offices also.**
- **Note to item 19:** the period may be **extended up to six years** for clerks, at the discretion of the Superintendent of the Stores Depot concerned.

### Rule 60-A — Clerks in Circle and administrative offices

A clerk in a Circle or Administrative office should not ordinarily remain **in the same section for more than four years at a time — except in the mail and sorting section and the PLI section, where the ceiling is five years.** (Rule 60-C stands *Deleted*; Rules 60-B and 60-D related to Telegraph Stores and Telephone Revenue offices.)

### Rule 61 — Cooling-off before return

An officer should not ordinarily be **brought back to the same Division, Sub-division or post** until the lapse of an interval **equivalent to the maximum period for which the post may be held** as fixed in the above rules.

### Rule 61-A — The five-year branch/office ceiling

Except when a longer tenure of service against a post has been specifically prescribed — or is authorised by orders of the Head of the Circle in any special contingency — **no official shall be retained in the same branch (in the case of a First Class Head Office) or in the same office (in the case of other post offices) for more than 5 years; and he**



shall **not be eligible for posting back to the same branch or office until after three years** of the date of his last posting there.

### **Rule 62 — Strict compliance**

The rotation orders contained in Rules 59 to 61, in so far as they relate to the officials mentioned therein, should be **followed strictly**; any deviation therefrom should **not be allowed unless the Head of the Circle is personally and fully satisfied about the need** for the same.

### **Rule 62-A — Considerations in transfer planning**

In addition to any personal requests for transfer which may be made, the considerations to be kept in view by the competent authorities are:

- (a) affording the staff an **equitable opportunity** of availing themselves of the facilities for better technical knowledge and experience in larger offices or services in better stations;
- (b) **retaining suitable officials** in duties the continuance in which might enable their utilisation to the best advantage of the service; and
- (c) meeting the **general needs of administration**.

**CURRENCY NOTE — Rotation and tenure as enforced today (VERIFIED)**

Rules 57–62-A remain the Manual’s base law, but the operative rotational-transfer framework is now the Directorate’s **Transfer Guidelines dated 17.01.2019 (F. No. 141-141/2013-SPB-II)**, modified on **17.11.2021** and consolidated on **03.02.2023**. Key operative norms: **post tenure of 3 years** (extendable by a maximum of one year); **station tenure of 6 years** for Circle-cadre officials; rotational transfers implemented **within 45 days**; re-transfer to a former post only **after 2 years**. Sensitive posts additionally attract the consolidated sensitive-post regime of **Order No. 4-7/2009-Vig. dated 02.04.2025** — covered in full in Section 11 below. The 2019 guidelines contain an express savings clause: **provisions of Postal Manual Volume IV not incorporated in the guidelines continue to prevail** — so the cadre-specific tenures of Rule 60 (e.g. 6 months for SB clerks, 1 year for cash-handling clerks) remain good law where the guidelines are silent. Directorate reiterations dated **11.12.2025** and **23.06.2026** have directed Circles to report and rotate officials exceeding 3 years in the same branch / 6 years at the same station.

**For the examination:** quote the Manual figures (4 years for Divisional heads, ASPs and IPs; the Rule 60 table) when the question cites the Manual, and the 3-year post / 6-year station tenure when the question cites the current transfer guidelines. Both appear in recent papers.

**10. Transfer of Charge of the Head of an Office (Rules 72–75)****Rule 72 — Governing rules**

The relief of the head of an office is conducted according to the **general rules laid down at the beginning of this Chapter** and the following rules. (Rules 76 and 77 stand *Deleted*.)

**Rule 73 — Duties of the relieved officer**

The relieved officer must give the relieving officer the **benefit of his local knowledge**, and point out any orders which may have been issued **especially for the guidance of the officer in charge** of the office. He must also give him his **opinion as to the character of the different employees** attached to the office. He will further make over a **memorandum** of: orders remaining to be complied with; objections outstanding; deductions to be made; etc. — **sending a copy to the Head of the Circle**. The relieved officer should also trace out, with the relieving officer, the office connections and explain the technical arrangements of the office generally.

**Rule 74 — “My predecessor never told me” is no excuse**

Officers in charge may **not put forward, as an excuse** for the non-submission or late submission of periodical office returns — or for the non-performance or irregular performance of office routine work — that they were **not instructed on these points by their predecessors**. Such excuses are **entirely invalid**, and show that the persons making them have a very imperfect notion of their duties and a very unsatisfactory knowledge of the rules. **It is the first imperative duty of every officer, before taking charge of an office, to acquaint himself thoroughly with the routine work of the office in all its details**; and he should, immediately after assuming charge, carefully read the letters and communications on the office file, so as to avoid unnecessary enquiries. Heads of Circles should satisfy themselves that this has been done, as much time is unnecessarily expended in calling for overdue returns, explanations, etc.

### **Rule 75 — Report of assumption; distribution of receipts**

The relieving officer will then **report to the Head of the Circle that he has taken charge**. The relieved officer will forward **one copy of the receipts (Form A.C.G.-61)** obtained from the relieving officer **to the Head of the Circle and one copy to the Postal Accounts Office** concerned, **retaining another in his own possession** — and will then **immediately proceed to his destination**.

#### **EXAM TIP — The three copies of Rule 75**

**Relieved officer's ACG-61 receipt copies: (1) Head of Circle, (2) Postal Accounts, (3) retained by himself.** Pair this with Rule 48 (gazetted charge reports by post to the next higher authority + Accounts Officer + DG) and Rule 55 (all charge-report copies signed by both officers) for a complete picture of charge-report distribution.

## 11. Current Overlay — Sensitive and Non-Sensitive Posts (Orders of 2025–26)

The rotation rules of this Chapter now operate alongside a consolidated vigilance framework. By **Order No. 4-7/2009-Vig. dated 02.04.2025** (DoP, Vigilance Division — signed by Director (Vigilance)), issued in view of **CVC Circular No. 22/10/22 dated 22.10.2022** and with the approval of **Sr. DDG (Vig) & CVO and Secretary (Posts)**, all earlier orders on the identification of sensitive and non-sensitive posts were revisited and consolidated. Every IP/ASP-level functionary handles this order in practice, and it is squarely examinable.

### 11.1 Unit-wise identification — the essentials

| Unit (para)                                                                       | Sensitive posts include                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Non-sensitive posts include                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Postal Directorate (3.1)                                                          | All Group 'A' posts of SAG level & above (with named DDG exceptions); all posts in DE Section, VP Section, Vigilance Division, PMU Division, Admin Section, C&A Section, GA Section and Personnel Division [SPN & SPG Sections] (except MTS); Engineering Wing — all posts except the planning/design line; Finance Wing — all SAG level & above                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | DDG (PG), DDG (PO), DDG (Estt.), DDG (SR & Legal), DDG (Training & CP); all Group A/B/C posts below SAG level except those named sensitive; Engineering planning & design posts (AEE/EE/SE/Architect line, office staff); Finance Wing posts below SAG                                                                                                                                                    |
| BD&M / PLI / Parcel Directorates (3.2)                                            | CGM, BD Directorate; CGM, PLI Directorate; CGM, Parcel Directorate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | All other posts                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| RAKNPA / PTCs / Circle & Regional Offices / Divisions / Sub-Divisions / MMS (3.3) | All Group 'A' posts of JAG level & above — all CPMsG, PMsG, DPS, Joint Director-I RAKNPA (with exceptions); all JTS/STS/PS Group 'B' officers holding a Division independently; Chief Postmaster in GPO; Sr. Postmasters and all other JTS/STS/PS Gr. B posts; all posts in PSD; all Group 'B' (gazetted/non-gazetted) officials dealing with Vigilance, Transfer & Posting, Recruitment, Building and Procurement; Sub-Divisional Heads (ASP/IP) in RMS/Postal Divisions; Mail Overseer; GM/Director (Finance/Accounts) and all Regional IFA posts; ALL posts in MMS units | PMG (BD), PMG (MM), PMG (Mails); DPS (BD), DPS (MM), DPS (Mails); Joint Director-II RAKNPA; posts not handling procurement/recruitment/vigilance/transfer-postings — e.g. APMG/AD/DDM/ADM of Mails, BD, PG, PO, Estt., PLI, Legal, Staff Relations, Welfare, Planning, Training, Quality Service; Deputy SPOs; Supdt. Sorting; Manager SPC; officers working in subordinate capacity in CO/RO; MTS in PSD |

| Unit (para)                                                                       | Sensitive posts include                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Non-sensitive posts include                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Post Offices / BPCs / Foreign Post / AMPCs / HRO / SRO / E-commerce Centres (3.4) | ALL Group 'B' and 'C' posts (including Postmaster Grade) in single- and double-handed post offices, Business Post Centres, E-commerce Centres, BNPL Centres, Savings Bank counters, and Manager BNPL/BPC/NSH; in other post offices — posts handling Treasury, cheque clearance, billing, counter operations, claim cases, PA/SA working as System Managers or Marketing Executives, staff of CPC (PLI and CBS), Supervisor SBCO, Head Record Officer (HRO) and Sub-Record Officer (SRO) in RMS Divisions | Against single/double-handed offices etc.: NIL — every post there is sensitive. In other offices: Account Branch, Mails, SBCO, SBSO, Sub-Account, PG/CCC and counters other than those named sensitive — e.g. HSA, Supervisors (RMS), Sorting Assistants not in counter operations/BPC/BNPL or working as System Managers/Marketing Executives |

#### NOTE — Vigilance Division posts

All posts in the Vigilance Division shall **continue to be identified as sensitive** as per CVC Circular No. 07/02/22 dated 03.02.2022 — the one category the 02.04.2025 order expressly footnotes.

### 11.2 The “Most-Sensitive” postings (para 4)

The following posts in operational/administrative offices are **Most-Sensitive**, and **no relaxation whatsoever over and above the prescribed tenure is to be allowed** while posting officers/officials on them:

- (i) all posts of **SPM/PA in single- and double-handed post offices**;
- (ii) all supervisory posts / PA / SA / Marketing Executives working in **Business Post Centres, BNPL Centres, E-commerce Centres** or other bulk-mail/business centres;
- (iii) all officials working as **System Managers and Marketing Executives in any office** — including CO/RO/DO/HO;
- (iv) all supervisory officers / PAs / SAs working in **CPCs, CBS and PLI**, including those in SDC/CEPT;
- (v) all supervisory officers / PAs / SAs working in branches like **Treasury / Billing / Cashier / Stock / Staff / Recruitment**; and
- (vi) all staff/sections dealing with **COD letters and COD parcels**.

**Para 4.1:** the **deputation period / local arrangement** of officers/officials on the above posts is **also counted towards their prescribed tenure** — tenure cannot be stretched by dressing a posting up as an “arrangement”.

### 11.3 Rotation, relatives and ODI (paras 5–7)

- **Para 5 — Rotation:** in view of the CVC instructions, **periodic rotation of officers/officials posted on sensitive posts is to be ensured every three years** to avoid developing vested interests.
- **Para 6 — Close relatives:** posting of **close relatives in the same office** — or in offices where one is in a capacity to **supervise or influence the other’s work** — should be **avoided**.
- **Para 7 — Officers with Doubtful Integrity (ODI):** where difficulty arises in posting an ODI officer on a non-sensitive post as the rules require, the **HoC/HoR may at his own discretion revise the work distribution or post the official on an equivalent post of the cadre** — ensuring that work of a sensitive nature (*Procurement, Recruitment, Transfer/Postings, Vigilance*) is **not entrusted** to such an officer.

### 11.4 Enforcement — the 2025–26 adherence letters

By letter **F. No. X-20/39/2023-SPN-II-DOP dated 11.12.2025**, the Personnel Division directed all Circles to adhere to the rotational-transfer guidelines and the sensitive-post instructions. Finding that many Circles were continuing officials on the same posts — or re-attaching them — even after completion of tenure, the Directorate issued a reiteration of **even number dated 23.06.2026** (ADG (SPN)) requiring every Circle to:

- ensure **strict compliance** with the 11.12.2025 rotational-transfer guidelines on sensitive and non-sensitive posts, with transfers carried out in a **transparent, fair and uniform manner**;
- review the period of posting of *all* officers/officials and **report to the SPN Branch within a fortnight, and thereafter on a quarterly basis**; and
- furnish **immediately** the details of officers/officials posted in the **same branch for more than 3 years or the same station for more than 6 years** — a ‘Nil’ report being required even where none exist.

**EXAM TIP — The 2025 order in one breath**

Order No. 4-7/2009-Vig. dt 02.04.2025, rooted in CVC Circular 22/10/22 dt 22.10.2022: sensitive posts identified unit-wise; single/double-handed PO posts have NIL non-sensitive entries; ASP/IP Sub-Divisional Heads and Mail Overseers are sensitive; six Most-Sensitive categories get no tenure relaxation and deputation counts; rotation every 3 years; Vigilance Division always sensitive (CVC 07/02/22 dt 03.02.2022); enforcement by letters dt 11.12.2025 and 23.06.2026 (3-yr branch / 6-yr station reporting).



## Chapter III — Leave (Rules 91–98)

*Chapter III does not itself confer leave — leave entitlements flow from the CCS (Leave) Rules, 1972 — but it prescribes the departmental machinery: the form of application, the one-month advance rule, the routing of the application, and the sanction and communication procedure. Rules 94, 95, 96 and 98 stand Deleted in the official text.*

### 1. Leave Applications (Rules 91–93)

#### Rule 91 — The prescribed form

An application for leave must be submitted in **Form S.R.-1**.

##### NOTE TO RULE 91 — GDS Sub-Postmasters

An application for leave from a **GDS Sub-Postmaster (BPM engaged to manage a sub-office in the older dispensation)** must be prepared in **Form App. 45**. It should be **preserved for three years after the connection of the GDS Sub-Postmaster with the Department ceases** — a favourite preservation-period question.

#### Rule 92 — One month in advance

An application for leave must ordinarily be submitted **one month in advance**, so as to enable the necessary arrangements to be made for the performance of the applicant's duties during his absence. Where an application is *not* submitted one month in advance, then — in the absence of adequate reasons for the delayed submission — the leave applied for is **liable to be refused or postponed**.

#### Rule 93 — Routing of the application

The application is submitted to the applicant's **immediate superior** who — if he is not the authority competent to sanction the leave — records his **recommendations and his proposal for filling up the vacancy** during the applicant's absence, and forwards the application **without further delay** to the officer who maintains the applicant's **service book/record and leave account** (in the case of a gazetted officer, the Accounts Officer concerned). That officer **examines the service book/record and the leave account** and records the **total amount of leave at the credit of the applicant in the certificate of admissibility** in the application form (or such other form as may be prescribed for gazetted officers), and forwards the form **expeditiously** to the authority competent to sanction the leave.

## 2. Sanction and Communication (Rule 97)

### Rule 97 — Verification of title and issue of orders

An officer who is authorised to sanction leave will **satisfy himself as to the title to the leave applied for** by reference to the **certificate of admissibility** recorded on the leave application. If the officer grants the leave, an **order will be issued specifying the arrangements ordered in consequence of the vacancy**, if any. Copies of the order are furnished to:

- the **Head of the applicant's office**;
- the **Head of the office from which the applicant's pay is drawn**;
- each of the **officials concerned** (i.e. affected by the arrangements);
- where the application was submitted to the Head of the Circle **through a supervising officer** — also to that **supervising officer**; and
- in the case of **gazetted officers** — also to the **Accounts Officer concerned**.

#### NOTE TO RULE 97

See **Rule 250 of Postal Manual, Volume II** regarding appointments to posts which require the incumbents to **furnish security** — leave arrangements against such posts must respect the security requirement.

## 3. Casual Leave (Rule 99 — opening principle)

Rule 99 opens the Manual's treatment of casual leave with the principle every aspirant must know: as indicated in Part V(2) of the administrative instructions reproduced in Appendix No. 3 to the Compilation of the Fundamental and Supplementary Rules, **casual leave is not a recognised form of leave** and is **not subject to any rules made by the Government of India** — an official on casual leave is treated as on duty.

**CURRENCY NOTE — Casual leave today**

The character of CL is unchanged — it is still not a recognised form of leave under the CCS (Leave) Rules, 1972, cannot be combined with regular leave, and cannot be claimed as of right. The present entitlement for Central Government employees is **8 days of casual leave per calendar year** (DoP&T consolidated instructions on CL/Special CL), with Restricted Holidays of 2 per year. Half-day CL is permissible; CL can be combined with holidays but the total absence should ordinarily not exceed the prescribed limits per current instructions.

## Quick Revision — The Numbers That Get Asked

| #  | Point                                                    | Figure / form                                                                             | Rule       |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1  | Persons dismissed for misconduct from any Govt post      | <b>Never employed</b>                                                                     | R. 3       |
| 2  | Re-employment of dismissed/resigned/absconded persons    | <b>Previous approval of DG</b>                                                            | R. 4       |
| 3  | Re-employment of pensioners — non-gazetted posts         | <b>HoC; Divisional/1st-class HPO authority within pension ceiling (Rs. 100 — archaic)</b> | R. 5       |
| 4  | Over-aged at appointment but within limit at recruitment | <b>No sanction needed</b>                                                                 | R. 10 N.1  |
| 5  | Office establishment excludes                            | <b>Sweepers</b>                                                                           | R. 11      |
| 6  | Petty-establishment definition does not apply to         | <b>The Post Office</b>                                                                    | R. 12 Note |
| 7  | Leave reserve — administrative offices                   | <b>14% of operative clerical staff</b>                                                    | R. 18/1    |
| 8  | Officiating outside the approved DPC list                | <b>Max 3 months</b>                                                                       | R. 27      |
| 9  | ADG selection — age ceiling                              | <b>Not above 50 years</b>                                                                 | R. 26 Note |
| 10 | Good-better-best: who is promoted                        | <b>The FIRST (senior fit) man</b>                                                         | R. 27-B    |
| 11 | Gazette: GoI notifications / DG & HoC notifications      | <b>Part I Sec. 2 / Part III Sec. 1</b>                                                    | R. 29      |
| 12 | Circle Gradation List — periodicity (official text)      | <b>Once in 2 years, corrected to 1st July (sources conflict — see note)</b>               | R. 32-A    |
| 13 | Gradation list — prescribed form                         | <b>Form App. 44</b>                                                                       | R. 32-C    |
| 14 | Error in gradation list — window to object               | <b>1 year from issue</b>                                                                  | R. 32-D    |
| 15 | Appeal against adverse seniority alteration              | <b>6 months from communication</b>                                                        | R. 32-D    |

| #  | Point                                             | Figure / form                                                   | Rule           |
|----|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 16 | Transfers normally made in                        | <b>April</b>                                                    | R. 37-A        |
| 17 | Own-request transfer without exchange — seniority | <b>Junior to all in new unit (as on date of transfer order)</b> | R. 38(2)       |
| 18 | Mutual exchange — place in new list               | <b>Whichever is lower</b>                                       | R. 38(1)       |
| 19 | Movement reports of transferred gazetted officer  | <b>On relief; on starting; weekly while in transit</b>          | R. 40          |
| 20 | Charge report / transit memo forms                | <b>ACG-61 / ACG-76</b>                                          | R. 43, 51      |
| 21 | Short vacancies — local officiating ceilings      | <b>≤ 1 month (station); &gt; 1 to ≤ 4 months (Division)</b>     | R. 50          |
| 22 | Divisional heads / ASPs / IPs — Manual tenure     | <b>4 years (current guidelines: 3-yr post / 6-yr station)</b>   | R. 57–59       |
| 23 | PO–RMS cross-experience exemption                 | <b>Superintendents above 45 years</b>                           | R. 58 Note     |
| 24 | SB / sub-accounts clerks                          | <b>6 months (extendable to 2 years, LSG+)</b>                   | R. 60(11)      |
| 25 | Cash/valuables-handling clerks (PO & RLO)         | <b>1 year</b>                                                   | R. 60(10),(16) |
| 26 | Village postmen (2+ in office)                    | <b>6 months</b>                                                 | R. 60(13)      |
| 27 | RMS sorting clerks in Supdt offices               | <b>5 years</b>                                                  | R. 60(12)      |
| 28 | Same branch of a 1st-class HO / same office       | <b>Max 5 years; return only after 3 years</b>                   | R. 61-A        |
| 29 | Relieved head of office — ACG-61 receipt copies   | <b>HoC + Postal Accounts + self</b>                             | R. 75          |
| 30 | Leave application — advance period / form         | <b>1 month / Form S.R.-1</b>                                    | R. 91–92       |

| #  | Point                                                                                                                                                          | Figure / form                                                      | Rule                            |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 31 | GDS SPM leave application — form / preservation                                                                                                                | App. 45 / 3 years after severance                                  | R. 91 Note                      |
| 32 | Casual leave                                                                                                                                                   | Not a recognised form of leave (today: 8 days/yr)                  | R. 99                           |
| 33 | Sensitive-post rotation (CVC-mandated)                                                                                                                         | Every 3 years — Order 4-7/2009-Vig. dt 02.04.2025                  | 2025 order, para 5              |
| 34 | Most-Sensitive posts (SPM/PA single & double-handed, BPC/BNPL/e-commerce, System Managers, CPC/CBS/PLI, Treasury/Billing/Cashier/Stock/Staff/Recruitment, COD) | No tenure relaxation; deputation counts                            | 2025 order, paras 4, 4.1        |
| 35 | Circle reporting of overstayed officials                                                                                                                       | > 3 yrs same branch / > 6 yrs same station — fortnight + quarterly | Letters 11.12.2025 & 23.06.2026 |

## — End of Postal Manual Vol IV: Chapters I–III (Rules 1–98) —

*Prepared by Dak Guru — A Self-Learning Portal*

### HOW TO USE THIS BOOKLET

Read each chapter's opening paragraph first — it frames what the rules are about. Focus your memory on the highlighted figures, the Rule 60 tenure table, the four-branch seniority tree of Rule 32-E, and the Quick Revision table, which capture the points most frequently tested in the LDCE IP and PS Group 'B' examinations.

*Wherever a "CURRENCY NOTE" appears, the Manual text has been overlaid by later orders; both versions are examinable, so read the note carefully to know which figure belongs to which source. Where sources conflict (e.g. gradation-list periodicity), the conflict is stated openly — verify the latest Directorate/Circle order before quoting a figure in official work.*

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